

A vintage photograph of two young women standing in front of a building with vertical slats. They are both wearing white qipaos. The woman on the right is holding a guitar. The word "TEMPO" is overlaid in a large, blue, stylized font. The photo has a scalloped border and is mounted on a dark background with other vintage photos visible around it.

TEMPO

TEMPO

To fulfill their grandma's dying wish, Dakota sets out to find her missing sister, who vanished during a war along with her music. Their search takes a turn upon meeting Tabitha, whose family sings their great aunt's songs at her temple.

WHY THIS TEMPO? (TIME IN ITALIAN)

Inspiration

This story is inspired by David's grandma and great aunt, who sold their guitar and music dreams to survive poverty after the Vietnam War. Grandma stayed in Saigon while Great Aunt gone nomad.

The Story Plays with Time/Tempo

The show uses a form of storytelling in which Dakota's story is told in chronological order (starting when Dakota finds out about Grandma Jessica's dementia) and Jessica and Lorenza's story is told in reverse order (beginning the show when the War separated them, fifty years ago).



MEET TAB & CODA

Dakota, a lonely Midwestern musician, must fulfill Grandma Jessica's dying wish to reunite with her sister Lorenza, who went missing during a war long ago along with her music. In a region known as The Middle, their search takes a turn upon hearing a Middle Eastern poet sing Lorenza's songs at her temple.

Tempo explores themes of temporary love and pain, and music as a temple of memory and reconnections.



DAKOTA F. CHÉRY

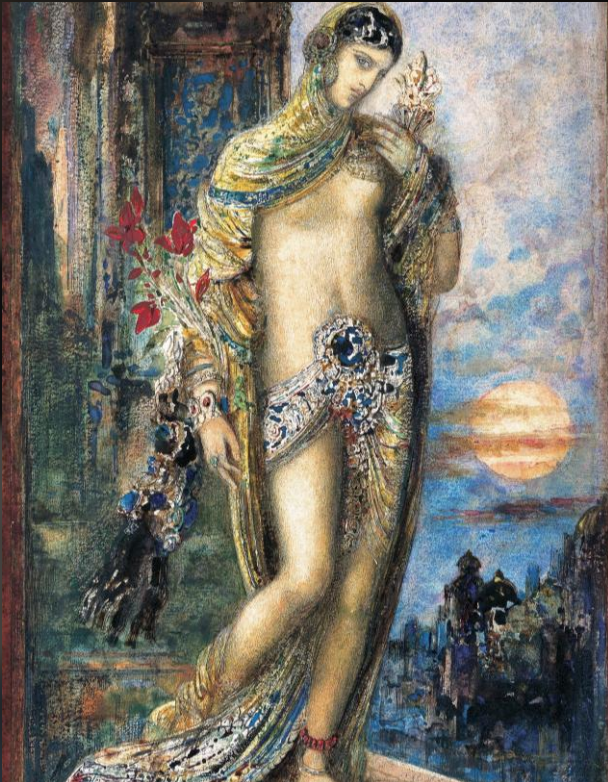


Kota is a lonely musician in the Midwest. Their parents prevent them from visiting their motherland. But when Grandma Jessica's dementia becomes severe, Kota sets out to help accomplish her dreams.

Gender: Any Ethnicity: Midwesterner

Age: 20s/30s

TABITHA GALILI



Tab is a poet and oud player in the Mideast. She lives to meet new people every day and dreams of starting a band.

Gender: W

Ethnicity: Middle Eastern

Age: 20s/30s

JESSICA & LORENZA



Jessica is Kota's grandma who was once a musician before losing her sister and guitar during the East War. She must reconnect with her sister Lorenza before dementia takes her. Grandma Jessica is her 84-year-old self.

Lorenza is Jessica's songwriting sister who vanished during the East War at age 20. She has nomadic ties to Tab. If alive today, she would be 80.

ALLEGRA KETSEV & LARGO GALILI



Allegra Ketsev and Largo Galili are Tab's mother and father. They run The Temple in The Middle.

MUSICAL NUMBERS

1. Nothing Lasts
2. Sunrise
3. The Moon Set
4. Mama Wants, Mama Gets
5. Out of Tune
6. The Lyrics Linger
7. Crescent
8. פֶּשָׁרִי (Efshari, Anything's Possible)
9. Liberty Nor Safety
10. Tab and Coda
11. Life is Over Before You Know It
12. Meet in the Middle
13. In Loving Destiny
14. Up to Speed/Slow Down
15. Moonrise
16. Sunset
17. Our Songs Live On



2003 Space Camp,
Huntsville, Alabama



Michigan State Uni.
Astrophysics, 2014-18



Andrea M. Ghez,
Nobel Prize, Physics



David Built an
Astronaut Costume



VP of ΣΠΣ, physics
honor society



King Arthur, his knights
conquered England!

~AND SPEAKING OF STAR~

DAVID QUANG PHAM

דוד קוואנג פאם

$9X - 7I > 3(3X - 7U)$,
SCIENCE!



David managed
a greenhouse
at MSU,
2015-16

An award-winning songwriter, filmmaker, and science educator. His work engages the public in scientific and cultural literacy and are within fantasy, adventure, sci-fi, and queer genres. He created the series *Photosynthesis*; *Star Zoos*; *The Sugarcoats*; and *Solid, Liquid, and Gas*; and the stage musicals *Chemicals in the Water*, *Ellipses*, and *Turnover: A New Leaf*. His musicals have been staged regionally, Off-Broadway, and internationally. He is the 2026 Cinephilia fellow, Kellogg's Foundation film fellow, 2024 Great Performances fellow, 2022 Harriet Tubman Effect Institute composer, 2021 Playwrights Foundation fellow, and 2020 Working Title Playwrights apprentice. Pham received a BS with honors in astrophysics and theatre from Michigan State University. Be up to lightspeed at www.science.studio or @ScienceTheatre.

LET'S CREATE SPACE AND TIME TOGETHER

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Check out **Photosynthesis**,
a musical animated series in the works!

